
A FOOL'S GLOSSARY

AVERAGE INVESTOR: born loser

BULL MARKET: rising market; a time when your neighbor's stocks are going up

BEAR MARKET: falling market; a time to lose whatever you might accidentally have made during a bull market

CORRECTION: short-term downswing in an otherwise rising market; wishful thinking by investors in a bear market (see also: Russian Correction of 1917, World Corrections I and II, the Bubonic Correction, etc.)

SAVINGS: whatever you had before you invested it

SUCCESSFUL INVESTOR: liar

PORTFOLIO MANAGER: expert who invests huge sums for mutual funds, pension funds; person who is highly paid to underperform the market averages

INSIDE INFORMATION: something you wish they'd tell you; what everybody else has heard

CORPORATE ANALYST: person who studies a company's prospects, predicts future earnings, etc.; expert who tells the shareholders what the bankers want them to hear; expert who tells little shareholders what big shareholders want them to hear; expert who tells the company what it already knows

MERGERS AND ACQUISITIONS: two ways in which companies are combined with other companies; two proven methods of turning various profitable enterprises into one big loser

RESTRUCTURING: modifying a company from within to enhance shareholder value; hiding the biggest mistakes

DIVESTITURE: way in which a company sells off its subsidiaries; getting rid of all the losers from the latest mergers and acquisitions

LEVERAGE: controlling a large investment with a smaller amount of money; betting more than you can afford to lose